Rosedale 3 Pitch Rules

Rosters

Preliminary Rosters are to be submitted by a team rep 3 weeks prior to the season start. Preliminary rosters must include the team's name, team member first and last name, team member birthdate, team member phone and/or email contact. The preliminary rosters can be modified up until the final roster due date. Preliminary rosters must include the minimum number of players (16) as specified by the league in order to reserve your spot in the league.

Final Rosters are to be submitted 72 hours prior to the first night of official league play. Failure to meet these expected deliverables will result in the following penalties: Preliminary roster not submitted on time: TBD (i.e. 1 game suspension for team reps), Final Roster not submitted on time: TBD (entire team will be suspended for xx games, or will forgo the season all together). NOTE: Sanctions to be determined and still to be voted on by council.

"By submitting this roster in electronic format, without player signatures, the team representative confirms and takes responsibility that all the players listed have read and agree to abide by the City of Hamilton Zero Tolerance Policy. Any instance where disciplinary action is taken against a rostered player in violation of this policy may also lead to sanctions against the team representative, at the discretion of the Executive Council. "

Teams

Each team shall consist of 16 players minimum on their roster, eight men and eight ladies and a maximum of 32 rostered players in total. Teams will field ten players with a minimum of five ladies (or 4 ladies with an automatic out). Fielding shall be as follows:

1 catcher ***4 infielders*** ***3 outfielders*** ***2 rovers***

Bases

All bases are to be pegged ~~fifty-five~~ sixty (60) feet apart with the provided safety bag at first. It is the responsibility of the home team to provide and set up the diamond or lose home field advantage (if the visiting team can set up the bases). If the visiting team does not have bases, the game is a default loss for the scheduled home team.

Bats

Only bats that bear the approved ASA 2004, USSA thumbprint OR NSA stamp and are not altered per below are permitted. The list of illegal bats include:

Miken Ultra
Miken Ultra 2
Combat Lady Virus
Jakd Nemesys

ALTERED BAT: A bat is considered altered when the physical structure of a legal bat has been changed, or an illegal or non-approved bat has been changed to resemble a legal bat. Examples of altering a bat are, but not limited to, the following: painting a bat, replacing the handle of a metal bat with a wooden or other type handle, or inserting material inside the bat. Compressing a bat in a vise or similar instruments, rolling, beating a bat with a rubber mallet, on a post or another bat; or any other process that exerts more pressure on the bat other than typical bat and ball collision is considered altering a bat.
EFFECT: *The ball is dead, the batter is out and base runners may not advance. The batter is ejected for using an altered bat.*

Batting

The batter is allowed three pitches and cannot switch hit during an at bat after the first pitch has been thrown. Batters must take a full, natural swing. Bunts and chop downs are called at the discretion of the umpire, and the batter will be out. A foul ball on the third pitch is an out. A ball hit higher than the batter's head and then caught is a foul/fly out.

Batting order

Batting out of order is an automatic out and all base runners return to the base that they started on. A player may be added to the bottom of the lineup if they arrive at the game late regardless of the inning, or removed from the lineup without penalty if there is the minimum number of required players for a team. There is no maximum for positioning consecutive players of the same gender in the batting order. The team rep may organize the batting order any way they choose, taking into consideration that as a courtesy in this league, we try to distribute men and women evenly through the order.

Blood rule

Any injury must be covered and have bleeding under control for a player to return to play.

Coaches and or team reps

Calling in Scores: Both team reps must email, text or call in the score of games, including a picture of the scoresheets, to the league convener (Dave Cummins) and the director of membership (Lindsay Poyton) within 72 hours of the game being played. Scores not emailed, texted or called in are considered a default.

On Field Dispute Resolution: All discussions regarding plays and rules, before and during a regular season game, are to be decided on by the umpire, involving the team reps only when necessary. Once a player informs their rep of the situation they are no longer involved. Players are not to leave the bench area or their position to get involved.

Default

A team is required to have and maintain a minimum number of 9 players to field a team including a minimum of 4 girls. A team with only 4 girls will have to mark a spot in the batting order as an automatic out and an out shall be called when this spot in the order comes to bat. There is no minimum requirement for male players (e.g a team can play with 9 players, 5 female and 4 male without an automatic out). Any team having less than the minimum required players at the end of the grace period (see Game Start Time below) or at any point in the game will lose by a score of 0 – 7. The use of players from other teams or non-league players is strictly prohibited. There are a maximum number of 4 defaulted games allowed per team during the season. Any more than that and the team will be barred from the playoffs.

Equipment

All teams are responsible for their own equipment. Damaged equipment must not be used.

Footwear

Metal spikes, removable cleats, or soccer style shoes are not permitted. Proper athletic footwear is required, which includes soft spikes.

Game Length and Mercy Rule

A game shall consist of eight innings total. Five innings will constitute a regulation game in the case of rain or darkness (Four and a half innings if the home team is leading). For regular season games, another inning cannot begin 80 minutes (1 hour, 20 minutes) after the start of the game. A mercy rule of seven runs per inning shall be in place for all regular season and tournament games until the last declared inning, depending on time. Unlimited runs are permitted in the last inning or the last declared inning, depending on time. Games are scheduled on a 90-minute time frame, but subsequent games will start when the one being played is finished.

Game Start Time

Game times and locations are indicated on the regular season schedule. A 15-minute grace period will commence at the time indicated on the schedule if either team does not have enough players to start. This time is included in the 80 minute time limit. Please keep in mind that this is a grace period and not to abuse it. **Note:** There is no grace period for playoff games.

Home Plate Out (Catchers)

The player must have full control of the ball and be in contact with home plate before a runner crosses the safety scoring line to constitute an out.

Home Run Rule

Match +1 after three for men and for women (two separate tallies). Each team will be allowed three (3) unanswered home runs over the fence per gender. They cannot score a fourth until the opposing team scores three. From then on, one team cannot go more than one home run up over the opposing team. If a home run over the fence will take a team two up, it will be considered an out regardless of the pitch count, and base runners may not advance.

For the purposes of this rule a home run is defined as any hit in fair territory that travels untouched over the outfield fence or into the netting. Should a ball go over the fence after making contact with a player, it will not count as a Match + 1 homerun. Additionally, any inside the park homerun also will not count as a Match +1 home run. If a batter has declared a substitute runner, and hits a home run, untouched, over the fence or into the netting, it will count as a Match +1 home run. The batter will proceed no further than first base, any existing base runners will score and time will be called. The substitute runner will then take the batter's place on first, and the game will proceed with the next batter.

Walk Off Home Runs

If a homerun is hit over the fence (considered a walk-off home run), the batter must proceed to touch first base and then may leave the field. Any existing base runners may also leave the field. All base runners and the batter will be counted as a run scored.

Infielders

Infielders must remain behind the base line until the ball is hit and must not block the base line if they are not involved in the play.

Infield Fly

The infield fly rule is ~~not~~ to be called. ~~If, in the umpire's discretion, an infielder intentionally drops an infield fly, the batter is awarded first base and all other runners advance one base.~~

Injuries

At any time during the game, if a player is injured and must leave and the team is left with less than the minimum number of players then that team will lose by forfeit. An injured players spot in the batting order will not result in an automatic out; however, that spot in the order will be crossed out and skipped going forward. The only exception to this would be if the team dropped down to 4 girls, then the injured girls spot would be an automatic out as specified in minimum player requirements.

Jewelry

Jewelry may be worn by players. At the umpire's discretion, a player may be asked to remove or cover up jewelry deemed to be a safety concern.

Line of no return

A line shall be drawn parallel to the first base line, twenty feet from home plate, off the third base line. If a runner passes this line they are committed to go home.

Outfielders

An outfielder cannot advance onto the infield to make a play at any time, regardless of the type of hit. Outcome is a dead ball and all runners advance one base plus the one they were going to at the time the fielder made contact with the ball. ~~Outfielders are allowed to throw to any base to make a play.~~ Outfielders are no longer allowed to throw a batter out at first base if the hit goes into the outfield. This is only on the initial at bat, and does not apply once the batter has established first base.

Overthrow in play

Runners advance at their own risk.

Overthrow out of play

Runners advance one base plus the base they were going to at the time the ball went out of play.

Pitchers

A player must be on the roster to be eligible to pitch in a game. A pitcher does not have to appear in the batting order. If the pitcher is not appearing in the batting order, their name must be written on the score sheet and initialed by the other team's representative in order for that game to count towards playoff eligibility. Pitchers may pitch from their own desired distance from home plate. If they are hit it constitutes a strike. If on the third pitch the pitcher is hit and there was an attempt to get out of the way then the pitch is taken over. Pitcher must not obstruct the fielding of the ball.

Pitching Nets

Pitching nets can be used at the discretion of each team. If a team chooses to use the net, the following will apply:

1. Net remains standing wherever the pitcher places it after the hit – no knocking it down. The pitcher should remain at the net instead of moving away and try to keep the line of sight clear from second base.
2. If the net is hit by the batted ball, it is treated the same as hitting the pitcher.
3. If a defensive player throws the ball and hits the net, it is a dead ball. Runners will continue to advance to the base they were approaching if they are more than half way to the base when the net is hit.

Player Eligibility

Eligibility – All Games:

- All players must be registered with the Rosedale 3 Pitch League and must be 19 years of age prior to playing in a game.
- All players must wear the league approved jersey bearing their team's approved colour(s), along with proper athletic attire, including footwear, to be eligible to play. No shirt, no play. **Note – if a player is new to the team, and does not have an approved team jersey, they may wear any shirt of the same base colour as the team jersey.
- If a player is wearing other than their team jersey, and it is of the same colour as the opposing team, they will be removed from play.
- Team shirt designs, including but not limited to sponsor logos, sublimation and the addition of any colours that are not on the team's pre-approved colour listing, must be approved by the Council prior to use.
- A player does not have to play a defensive inning nor a pitching inning to be eligible to be in the batting lineup.

Playoff Eligibility: To be eligible for the playoffs, a minimum half the regular season games less one must be played.

Playoff Eligibility Exceptions: Any player 50 years old or older does not need to meet the above playoff eligibility requirement. Proof of age can be requested by the Registrar. At the pre-playoff league meeting, each team can submit a list of four additional player exceptions – these players must have played

a minimum of 7 games to be eligible. These four (4) players eligibility will be confirmed by the Director of Membership / Registrar. Once confirmed they will be eligible to play. No vote by remaining team reps is necessary. All scorebooks must be brought to this meeting for eligibility validation purposes.

All score sheets must be made available for review by an executive member upon request.

Playoff & Tournament Games

As in regular season, an inning is not to start 80 minutes beyond the start time of each game. In the event of a tie at the end of the game, the score will revert back to the last non-tied score inning. The highest-ranking team at the end of the regular season will have home team privileges.

Tiebreakers **Year End Standings**

1) Points earned
2) Winning percentage
3) Head to head
4) Plus/minus

Tournament

1) Games won
2) Head to head
3) Plus/minus (NOTE: playoff and tournament games are to be played out until the winning team meets the plus 7 maximum run differential.
4) Runs allowed

Protests

Protests will not be allowed during any game where there are no umpires with which to file a complaint. Any protests filed will be handled according to SPO rules. The protesting team must submit the $150 fee (cash or cheque up front) for filing a protest to an Executive Council member at the game.

Rainouts and Rescheduling Games

- Team reps must reschedule games within 3 weeks.
- To reschedule a game, a team rep must contact the other team rep and convener 48 hours prior to game time to advise of the reschedule request.
- After two attempts to reschedule a mutual decision to change a game, the convener should be notified.
- Teams will not be permitted to accumulate more than two games to be rescheduled without explanation to the convener.
- In the event that a scheduled double-header cannot be satisfactorily rescheduled, teams are not allowed to split the wins.
- Points will not be awarded for games not played. Exception: Council may choose to apply a 0-0 tie for games that could not be reasonably rescheduled (eg. late season rainouts).

Rescheduling Games

- Please have two dates and times agreed to by both reps to aid in a diamond request.
- Please call the convener for a diamond request.

Returning the ball to the pitcher

Any player on the infield may return the ball to the pitcher. A ball thrown from the outfield may be ignored by the pitcher and is considered an overthrow.

Rovers

Rovers must take their position in the outfield and may advance onto the infield once the ball has been hit.

Safety Scoring Line

A line shall be drawn parallel to the first base line, off the left corner of home plate. Runners must cross this line rather than touching home plate. If a runner does touch home plate then it is an automatic out. There is no tagging permitted between the line of no return and the safety line.

Sliding Across Safety Scoring Line

Sliding is not permitted across scoring line near home plate. Runner is out and all other base runners must return to the last base they reached safely prior to the infraction.

Substitute Runner

A batter may request a substitute runner under two circumstances:

Injury during the game – A batter injured during a play may request a substitute runner on any base. This player must continue to get a substitute runner for subsequent at-bats for the remainder of the game. The substitute runner shall be of the same gender and the last out in the lineup. If no outs have been made (i.e. first inning) the substitute runner will be the player of the same gender furthest away from the injured batter in the lineup. NOTE: if a player is pulled by an umpire to resolve an injury with blood, they may continue their next at bat without a substitute runner.

Previously existing injury – A batter may request a substitute runner provided he has notified the umpire prior to batting. Once he or she has arrived safely at first base and no farther, the last out of the same gender in the lineup will take his/her place at first base. If no outs have been made (i.e. first inning) the substitute runner will be the player of the same gender furthest away from the injured batter in the lineup. This player must continue to get a runner for subsequent at-bats.

Tie Games

If the score is tied at the end of regulation, another inning(s) may be played until the tie is broken, time permitting, upon the agreement of both team reps. At the start of each extra inning, a runner is placed on second base with the intent of accelerating opportunities to score and bringing the game to a speedier conclusion. The runner will be the last batter to make an out in the previous inning. At least one full inning is played, allowing each team the same chance to score. If the score remains tied, the same process is used in each inning until a victor emerges (one team scores more runs than the other at the end of a complete inning). For regular season games, another inning cannot begin after 80 minutes from the start of the game. If at the end of the time limit of a regular season game, the score is still tied, it will remain a tie.

**Playoffs and Tournament weekend games only - If at the end of a game the score is tied, then extra innings may be played as time permits. If the score is tied and the time limit (per scheduling) has been reached, the final score will revert back to the last completed and untied inning to declare a winner.

Umpires

For any games where umpires are not supplied the pitcher shall be the umpire, with the back catcher calling foul balls and out of play. If a pitcher misses a call they may go to the base coach, on the opposite side of the play in question, for a ruling (1st coach to call 3rd and home, 3rd coach to call 1st and 2nd).

THE DRINKING OF ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES AND THE USE OF VIOLENCE IS STRICTLY PROHIBITED IN PUBLIC PARKS, IN ACCORDENCE WITH PARKS BYLAW #77-221 AND THE ZERO TOLERANCE POLICY.

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